

Lesson 13: “This Generation Shall Have My Word through You” (See [Class Member Study Guide](#))

Purpose: To help us appreciate the Prophet Joseph Smith’s role in bringing forth the word of the Lord in this dispensation.

Related Videos: [Message of the Restoration](#) (Elder L. Tom Perry, 2:22)

Image: [Mary and Caroline Rollins Saving the Book of Commandments](#).

1. The Lord declared that our dispensation would receive His word through Joseph Smith.

• D&C 5:10. “But this generation shall have my word through you”. †1. Brigham Young

How is this statement true for you? How is it true for all Latter-day Saints?

The “great outpouring of truth in this dispensation has come through the Prophet Joseph Smith. For example, latter-day scriptures, priesthood ordinances, the organization of the priesthood, and temple building have come from the Lord through the Prophet Joseph Smith.” (*Lesson Manual*)

2. Many ancient and latter-day scriptures have come through Joseph Smith.

• Moses 1:40-41. In “a day when the children of men shall esteem my words as naught ... I will raise up another like unto thee; and they shall be had again among the children of men—among as many as shall believe.”

How is this prophecy being fulfilled?

What scriptures have come to us through the Prophet Joseph Smith? †2. Elder LeGrand Richards

The Book of Mormon

• 2 Nephi 3:11-15. “But a seer will I raise up out of the fruit of thy loins”.

In what ways does the Book of Mormon help eliminate contention and establish peace?

In what ways does the Book of Mormon bring people to a knowledge of the Lord’s covenants?

How has the Book of Mormon blessed your life?

What are some of your favorite passages in the Book of Mormon?

The Doctrine and Covenants †3. The Book of Commandments

• [Our Heritage, p. 41](#). The Story of Mary Elizabeth Rollins and her sister Caroline save some unbound pages.

“The pages that were salvaged were bound into a few copies of the Book of Commandments, but the revelations still were not widely available. In 1835, after 45 more revelations were added, the Book of Commandments was published as the Doctrine and Covenants.” (*Lesson Manual*)

How can we value the Doctrine and Covenants more highly?

How have you been blessed as you have studied the Doctrine and Covenants this year?

What are some of your favorite passages in the Doctrine and Covenants?

The Pearl of Great Price †4. Pearl of Great Price—Background

• Introductory Note—last five paragraphs. These explain the background of each part of this book of scripture.

How have the teachings of the Pearl of Great Price helped you?

What are some passages in the Pearl of Great Price that are particularly meaningful to you?

The Joseph Smith Translation of the Bible

• Eighth Article of Faith. We believe the Bible is the word of God “as far as it is translated correctly”.

• 1 Nephi 13:24-28. The Bible is “the book proceeded forth from the mouth of a Jew”.

†5. Great and Abominable Church

Bible

Enoch: Gen. 5:18-24, Luke 3:37; Hebrews 11:5; and Jude

Matthew 4

Joseph Smith Translation

Moses 6:21-68; Moses 7:1-69

Footnotes for Matthew 4 that begin with “JST”

How do these corrections clarify the verses in the King James Version?

• [Our Heritage, p. 24](#). Joseph Smith Translation of the Bible, of John 5:29 led to the revelation of D&C section 76.

3. Plain and precious doctrines of the gospel have been restored through Joseph Smith.

†6. Chart of “some of the doctrines of the gospel that were restored or clarified through the Prophet Joseph Smith.”

Next Week: Lesson 14: “The Law of Consecration”; See L14 [Class Member Study Guide](#). † •

(You can download a free LDS Institute manual at: [Doctrine and Covenants Manual: Religion 324 and 325](#).)

Physical nature of the Godhead
Our creation in God's image
Apostles and prophets
Melchizedek Priesthood
Aaronic Priesthood
Mode of baptism
The gift of the Holy Ghost
Premortal existence
Baptism for the dead
Resurrection
The three kingdoms of glory
Eternal marriage
Our potential to become like Heavenly Father

†1. **Brigham Young:** "What I have received from the Lord, I have received by Joseph Smith" (*Discourses of Brigham Young*, sel. John A. Widtsoe [1941], 458).

†2. **Elder LeGrand Richards:** "As far as our records show, he has given us more revealed truth than any prophet who has ever lived upon the face of the earth" ("[Call of the Prophets](#)," *Ensign*, May 1981, 33).

†3. **The Book of Commandments:** "From "1823 to 1831, Joseph Smith received more than 60 revelations from the Lord. A few handwritten copies of these revelations were given to missionaries and others, but most Church members did not have access to them. At a conference held in Ohio in late 1831, Church leaders decided to publish the revelations in a volume called the Book of Commandments (see the headings to D&C 67 and D&C 69). Oliver Cowdery and John Whitmer were selected to take the revelations to Independence, Missouri, a distance of approximately 1,000 miles, where the book would be printed and bound.

"... This is the first compilation of the revelations given through the Prophet Joseph Smith. These revelations later became part of the Doctrine and Covenants.

"Oliver Cowdery and John Whitmer reached Independence in January 1832, and by July 1833 William W. Phelps had printed the first 160 pages of the Book of Commandments. However, on 20 July 1833 a mob destroyed Brother Phelps's printing press and many of the unbound pages of the Book of Commandments." (*Lesson Manual*)

†4. **Pearl of Great Price— Background:** "Like a pearl, it is small in size but great in worth. Although it is only 61 pages long, it spans the eternities, including passages about the Grand Council in Heaven, the restoration of the gospel in the dispensation of the fullness of times, the Savior's Second Coming, the Millennium, and everlasting life. It contains valuable teachings on the Creation, the Fall, the Atonement, and the agency of mankind. This book of scripture has five parts:

- a. Selections from the book of Moses
- b. The book of Abraham
- c. Joseph Smith—Matthew
- d. Joseph Smith—History
- e. The Articles of Faith (*Lesson Manual*)

†5. **Great and Abominable Church:** "The phrase 'great and abominable church' refers to all those who fight against God, not to a specific church.) ... because of the Great Apostasy, the Lord withdrew the fullness of the gospel from the earth. During the centuries that followed, many parts of the Bible were changed and many plain and precious truths were lost.

"Soon after the Church was restored, the Lord instructed the Prophet Joseph Smith to begin making inspired corrections to the King James Version of the Bible. There are many references to this instruction in the Doctrine and Covenants (see, for example, D&C 35:20; 37:1; 45:60-61; 73:3-4; 93:53). Today we refer to the Prophet's work as the Joseph Smith Translation of the Bible.

"Joseph Smith's translation of the Bible differs from what we normally call a translation. The Prophet did not translate the Bible from one language to another. His only text was the King James Version of the Bible, and he was guided by the Spirit to make corrections and restore passages that had been lost completely.

"Two excerpts from the Joseph Smith Translation are in the Pearl of Great Price (the book of Moses and Joseph Smith—Matthew). In addition, brief portions of the Joseph Smith Translation are included in the footnotes of the Latter-day Saint edition of the King James Bible. Longer excerpts are included in the appendix following the Bible Dictionary...

"The process of translating the Bible not only brought the correction and restoration of doctrines in the Bible. It also helped bring about the restoration of doctrines through the Doctrine and Covenants. Many revelations in the Doctrine and Covenants are responses to questions the Prophet asked while pondering the translation of the Bible..." (Robert J. Matthews, in *The Capstone of Our Religion: Insights into the Doctrine and Covenants* [1989], 64). (*Lesson Manual*)

Recommended Reading:

1. Teachings of Presidents of the Church: Joseph Smith, "[Chapter 16: Revelation and the Living Prophet](#)," (2011), 192-205.
2. President Gordon B. Hinckley, "[Joseph Smith Jr.—Prophet of God, Mighty Servant](#)," *Ensign*, Dec. 2005, 2-6.
3. Gerrit Dirkmaat, "[Great and Marvelous Are the Revelations of God](#)," *Ensign*, Jan. 2013, 44.

Visit stephenmbird.com

†6. **DC L13 Chart** shows how Joseph Smith’s revelations clarify, enlarge, and illuminate our understanding of these biblical doctrines.

Subject	Bible Scriptures	Scriptures through Joseph Smith
Physical nature of Godhead	Matthew 3:16-17; John 4:24; Acts 7:55	Joseph Smith—History 1:17; D&C 130:1, 22
Our creation in God’s image	Genesis 1:27	Moses 6:8-9
Apostles and prophets	Ephesians 2:20; 4:11-16	D&C 107:23, 33, 35, 39, 58; D&C 112:30-32
Melchizedek Priesthood	Hebrews 6:20; 7:17	D&C 84:19-25; 107:1-8, 18-19
Aaronic Priesthood	Hebrews 7:11	D&C 13; 84:18, 26-27, 30; D&C 107:1, 13-14, 20
Mode of baptism	Matthew 3:16	3 Nephi 11:22-26; Moroni 8:8-12; D&C 20:71-74
The gift of the Holy Ghost	Acts 8:17	D&C 20:41, 43; 35:6; 121:46
Premortal existence	Jeremiah 1:4-5	D&C 93:29; Abraham 3:22-26
Baptism for the dead	1 Corinthians 15:40-42	D&C 76:50-112; 131:1
Eternal marriage	Genesis 2:24 1 Corinthians 11:11	D&C 131:1-4; 132:19
Our potential to become like Heavenly Father	Romans 8:17	D&C 88:107; 93:20; 132:20-24

Further Enrichment Resources:

1. Michael R. Ash, “[The Restoration and Early Christian Teachings](#),” *Ensign*, Apr. 2013.
2. R. Scott Lloyd, “[New Website Gives Story Behind D&C Sections](#),” Church News and Events, 22 Feb. 2013; accessed on 3/19/13.
3. “[Revelations in Context Section Index](#)”.
4. Kay Darowski, “[D&C 4, 11, and 23: Joseph Smith’s Support at Home](#),” 28 December 2012.
5. Elder David A. Bednar, “[Line upon Line, Precept upon Precept](#),” (2 Nephi 28:30), *New Era*, Sept. 2010, 2-7.)

Elder David A. Bednar to our youth: “You are eager and anxious to learn the doctrines of the restored gospel... One question is asked over and over again as we meet with you: *“How can I tell the difference between my emotions telling me what I want to hear and the Holy Ghost telling me what I need to hear?”* ...

“I believe many of us unknowingly accept a faulty assumption about the Lord’s pattern... And that faulty assumption and our misinformed expectations ultimately hinder our ability to recognize and respond to the promptings of the Holy Ghost. Let me suggest that many of us typically assume we will receive *an* answer or a prompting to our earnest prayers and pleadings. And we also frequently expect that such an answer or a prompting will come immediately and *all at once*. Thus, we tend to believe the Lord will give us A BIG ANSWER QUICKLY AND ALL AT ONE TIME. However, the pattern repeatedly described in the scriptures suggests we receive “line upon line, precept upon precept,” or in other words, many small answers over a period of time. Recognizing and understanding this pattern is an important key to obtaining inspiration and help from the Holy Ghost.” (“[Line upon Line, Precept upon Precept](#)” (2 Nephi 28:30), *New Era*, Sept. 2010, 2-7.)